

DIGITALAIKART - PREMIUM DIGITAL EDITION

THE AI VIDEO CREATOR PLAYBOOK

India Edition - 2026

Turn a prompt into a published video - and a paying audience.

Veo 3.1

AI VIDEO

Live in India at rupee prices

60

PROMPTS

Copy-paste video prompts

Rs 199

TO START

Cheapest serious entry

3

TRAPS

YouTube rules to survive

What this playbook gives you

The complete 2026 AI video workflow - script, shot list, generation, voice, edit, publish.

Every major tool priced in rupees, including which one to start with and why.

A 60-prompt library for video generation, scripts, hooks, titles and client work.

The exact YouTube rules (updated July 2026) that keep an AI-assisted channel monetizable.

A 30-day launch plan, the monetization stack, and how to sell AI video as a service.

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Contents

1 The Opportunity: India's Biggest Creator Break

Why 2026 is the year to start

2 The 2026 AI Video Toolkit for India

Tools, rupee pricing, what to pick

3 How AI Video Actually Gets Made

The seven-step production pipeline

4 Choosing a Niche That Pays

CPM data and the wedge rule

5 Writing Scripts the Algorithm Loves

Hooks, retention, and TTS-friendly copy

6 Prompting Video Models Like a Director

The prompt formula and shot language

7 Mastering Google Flow and Veo 3.1

Ingredients, scene builder, credits

8 Voice, Music and Audio That Don't Sound Fake

TTS, native audio, mixing

9 Editing, Captions and Assembly

Pacing, kinetic captions, aspect ratios

10 The Policy Playbook: Stay Monetizable

The July 2026 inauthentic-content rules

11 The Monetization Stack

Five income streams, with the maths

12 Growing Fast: Titles, Thumbnails, SEO

The Shorts plus long-form engine

13 Selling AI Video as a Service in India

Client menu, pricing, delivery

14 The 30-Day Launch Plan

Week-by-week from zero to published

15 Common Mistakes That Kill New AI Channels

Twelve traps and their fixes

16 Three Complete Example Scripts

Full scripts with their shot lists

17 The 90-Day Calendar and Batching System

Consistency without burnout

18 AI Video for Paid Ads and Campaigns

The higher-paying service line

19 Troubleshooting: When the Model Won't Cooperate

Ten problems and their fixes

20 Templates and Worksheets

Reusable checklists and briefs

21 90 Ready Video Topic Ideas

Three niches, thirty topics each

22 Where to Verify Every Number

The official sources to check

23 Three Niche Deep-Dives

Finance, tech and education

24 Client Communication Templates

The messages that win work

25 Worked Earnings Examples

The arithmetic, shown honestly

26 The First 1,000 Subscribers

The fastest path to monetisation

27 Shorts: The Growth Engine, Done Right

The system, not the lottery

A 60-Prompt Library

Copy-paste prompts for every stage

B Tool Comparison and Cost Worksheet

Pick a stack, plan your budget

C Glossary of AI Video Terms

Every term in plain English

D Frequently Asked Questions

Twelve common questions answered

E The One-Page Cheat Sheet

The whole method on a single page

F Sample 30-Day Publishing Calendar

A ready-to-run month

A note on facts: every tool price, policy rule and earning range in this playbook comes from official company pages, government or platform documentation, and dated 2026 reporting. Pricing in this market moves fast - always confirm the current figure on the official page before you subscribe.

CHAPTER 1

The Opportunity: India's Biggest Creator Break

Why 2026 is the year an ordinary person with a laptop can build a video audience.

India is now YouTube's largest market - and the tools finally fit the budget

The gate that opened - and the gate that slammed shut

Who this playbook is for

- **The complete beginner** who has never made a video and wants a step-by-step path from a blank page to a published upload.
- **The working professional or student** who wants a second income from a faceless channel without appearing on camera.
- **The freelancer or small agency** who wants to sell AI video production to local businesses at a healthy margin.
- **The existing creator** who wants to add AI to an established workflow without tripping the monetization rules.

What you will be able to do by the last page

CHAPTER 2

The 2026 AI Video Toolkit for India

Every major tool, priced in rupees, with a clear recommendation on where to start.

The four tools that matter, and what each is for

Tool	Best for	Entry price	Billing
Google Veo 3.1 (via Gemini, Flow, Vids)	The all-rounder: text-to-video with native synced audio and dialogue; built into apps you already have	Rs 399/mo (Rs 199 first 6 months) on AI Plus; free tier via Google Vids	Rupees, UPI and Indian cards accepted
Kling 3.0	High-volume Reels and Shorts; strong motion and multi-shot storyboarding	Free tier: 66 credits per day; Standard from about \$6.99 first month	USD - needs a card enabled for international transactions
Runway Gen-4.5	Cinematic control and an editing workflow; also runs third-party models	Free: 125 one-time credits; Standard about \$12/mo billed annually	USD
HeyGen / InVideo AI	Talking-head avatars and localisation (HeyGen); full script-to-video assembly (InVideo)	HeyGen free: 3 videos/mo; InVideo free plan is watermarked	USD

Start here: the two-tool stack for almost everyone in India

The Google AI plans, in rupees

Plan	Monthly (India)	Flow credits / month	Who it suits
AI Plus	Rs 399 (Rs 199 intro for 6 months)	200	Beginners and solo creators - the recommended start
AI Pro	Rs 1,950	1,000	Serious creators who need full Veo 3.1 quality and higher limits
AI Ultra	From Rs 6,500	10,000 to 25,000	Studios and high-volume production

What a video actually costs to generate

CHAPTER 3

How AI Video Actually Gets Made

The seven-step pipeline, and why planning beats prompting every single time.

The seven steps

- 1 **Idea and angle.** Pick one specific question your viewer is asking, and one clear answer you will give.
- 2 **Script.** Write the words first - hook, body, payoff - before touching a video tool.
- 3 **Shot list.** Break the script into 4 to 10 visual beats. Each beat becomes one generated clip.
- 4 **Generate.** Prompt each beat as its own clip, using the prompt formula in Chapter 6.
- 5 **Voice and audio.** Record or generate the narration, add music and sound effects.
- 6 **Edit and caption.** Cut the clips to the narration, add kinetic captions, tighten pacing.
- 7 **Publish and optimise.** Title, thumbnail, description, and a Shorts cut of the best moment.

The 90/10 rule

A worked example: from topic to shot list

CHAPTER 4

Choosing a Niche That Pays

Not all views are worth the same. The niche decides your income before you publish once.

What Indian niches actually pay in 2026

Niche	CPM range (Rs per 1,000 ad impressions)	RPM (your share, approx.)
Finance and insurance	150 - 500	80 - 250
Technology reviews	120 - 350	60 - 150
Health, wellness and pharma	100 - 300	40 - 100
Education and competitive exams	80 - 250	50 - 120
Business and entrepreneurship	80 - 160	60 - 140
Real estate and home	70 - 180	30 - 60
Entertainment and comedy	10 - 40	5 - 22
Music	8 - 30	4 - 16

The niches that work faceless

The wedge rule: narrow beats broad

Eight niches you could start this week

- **Tax-saving for salaried professionals** - evergreen, spikes every January to July.
- **Mutual fund and SIP explainers** - steady year-round advertiser demand from AMCs.
- **Insurance comparisons** - the single highest-CPM sub-niche in India.
- **Credit cards and credit score** - strong in Hindi, product-specific content wins.
- **AI tools for students and professionals** - fast-growing, tech CPMs, endlessly topical.
- **Competitive-exam explainers** - EdTech advertisers pay well for a focused student audience.
- **Business case studies** - 'how this Indian company grew' - faceless-friendly, high CPM.
- **Legal awareness in Hindi** - tenant rights, consumer protection - near-zero competition.

CHAPTER 5

Writing Scripts the Algorithm Loves

Attention is won in the first few seconds and defended every second after.

The hook: your only job in the first five seconds

The retention arc

- 1 **Hook (0-5s)**. State the payoff and the stake. No introductions, no 'hi guys'.
- 2 **Promise (5-20s)**. Tell them exactly what they will be able to do by the end.
- 3 **Payoff (20s-end)**. Deliver the content in clear steps, each with a small win.
- 4 **Loop (last 10s)**. Point to the next video, or return to the hook so the rewatch rate rises.

Write for the ear, not the page

Length: match the video to the job

CHAPTER 6

Prompting Video Models Like a Director

The formula that turns a sentence into a usable clip - and the vocabulary that makes it work.

The six-part prompt formula

- 1 **Subject.** Who or what is in frame - be specific ('a middle-aged Indian shopkeeper in a blue shirt').
- 2 **Action.** What happens in these seconds - one clear action, not a sequence.
- 3 **Setting.** Where and when - 'a small grocery shop in Mumbai, evening, warm light'.
- 4 **Camera.** Shot type and movement - 'medium shot, slow push in'.
- 5 **Light and style.** 'Soft golden light, documentary style, shallow depth of field'.
- 6 **Audio.** Ambient sound, music or dialogue - Veo 3.1 and Gemini Omni Flash generate audio natively.

The vocabulary that gets results

Category	Words the models understand
Shot type	extreme close-up, close-up, medium shot, wide shot, aerial, over-the-shoulder
Camera move	slow push in, pull out, pan left, tilt up, tracking shot, static, handheld
Lighting	golden hour, soft diffused light, dramatic side light, neon, natural daylight
Style	documentary, cinematic, minimalist, 3D animation, watercolour, retro film
Audio	ambient city noise, soft piano, gentle rain, no music, whispered narration

Five mistakes that waste credits

- **Too many instructions.** One action per clip. Two actions means the model picks one and drops the other.
- **No camera direction.** Leave the camera unspecified and you get a static, lifeless frame.
- **Contradictions.** 'Bright sunny day' plus 'moody night lighting' produces mush. Keep the world consistent.
- **Expecting long clips.** Models deliver seconds, not minutes. Design your video in short beats.
- **Ignoring the first frame.** In image-to-video, the starting image does most of the work - choose or generate it deliberately.

CHAPTER 7

Mastering Google Flow and Veo 3.1

The professional workspace that turns separate clips into a consistent, finished film.

What Flow adds that a plain prompt cannot

- **Ingredients.** Upload reference images of a character, object or background, and Flow keeps them consistent across scenes - the fix for 'my character looks different in every clip'.
- **SceneBuilder.** Assemble clips on a timeline and extend them, so a 4-second generation becomes a longer, flowing sequence.

- **Camera controls.** Direct the shot - push in, pan, tilt - instead of accepting whatever the model chooses.
- **Nano Banana image tools.** Generate or edit starting frames inside the workspace, feeding image-to-video.
- **Gemini in the workspace.** Edit and iterate in natural language rather than re-prompting from scratch.

A repeatable Flow workflow

- 1 Create a new project and choose the Veo 3.1 model.
- 2 Open the Ingredients panel and upload your reference character, object and background images.
- 3 Write your first scene prompt using the six-part formula from Chapter 6.
- 4 Generate at the Fast or Lite tier to check the composition cheaply.
- 5 Re-run only the clips you will keep at full quality.
- 6 Use SceneBuilder to lay the clips in order and extend the ones that need more time.
- 7 Export the finished sequence and take it into your editor for captions and sound.

Keeping characters and style consistent

CHAPTER 8

Voice, Music and Audio That Don't Sound Fake

Sound is half the video, and the half most AI creators neglect.

Your three audio layers

- 1 **Narration.** The voice that carries your script. Either record it yourself or generate it with text-to-speech.
- 2 **Music.** A single background bed, kept low. It sets mood and masks small audio gaps.
- 3 **Effects and ambience.** Small sounds - a page turn, city hum, a soft transition whoosh - that make scenes feel real.

Choosing between your own voice and a synthetic one

Getting the mix right

- Keep narration clearly on top; drop music to roughly a quarter of its full volume under speech.
- Use consistent loudness across videos so your channel feels professional.
- Add a short sound at every scene change - it subconsciously signals progress and holds attention.
- Leave a beat of silence after a key point; it makes the point land.

CHAPTER 9

Editing, Captions and Assembly

Where clips become a video. Pacing and captions do more for retention than anything else.

Pacing: cut every three to five seconds

Captions are not optional

Aspect ratios: match the shape to the platform

Format	Aspect ratio	Best for
Shorts / Reels	9:16 vertical	Reach, subscribers, discovery
Standard YouTube	16:9 landscape	Long-form watch time and ad revenue
Square (rare)	1:1	Some cross-posting to Instagram feeds

The assembly checklist

- Import your clips in shot-list order and lay them under the narration track.
- Trim each clip to the narration beat it belongs to; cut on the beat.
- Add captions and check they are in sync to the syllable.
- Drop the music bed to a quarter volume and add transition sounds.
- Watch the whole thing once on a phone, at arm's length, before you publish - that is how your viewer sees it.

CHAPTER 10

The Policy Playbook: Stay Monetizable

The rules that decide whether your AI channel ever earns a rupee. Get these right first.

The July 2026 rule, in plain English

- 1 **Generic or repetitive content.** Videos that look template-made, feel interchangeable from one to the next, or are mass-produced with minimal variation. Image slideshows and 'same storyline, same outcome' series are named directly.
- 2 **Unsatisfying or off-putting content.** Content built on emotionally manipulative formulas or designed to shock purely for views - for example, repetitive distress scenarios without a real narrative.
- 3 **AI personas on sensitive topics.** Synthetic identities presenting themselves as human experts on health, law, finance or politics - an AI 'doctor' giving health advice, an AI 'host' giving investment tips.

The 'add your voice' test

AI disclosure: when and where

- **Disclose:** realistic AI scenes, AI-generated music, making a real person appear to say or do something they did not.
- **Do not need to disclose:** obviously animated or stylised content, and minor aesthetic edits.
- **Never do:** use AI to fake a real event, a real person's words, or a real disaster.

The channel-level review

CHAPTER 11

The Monetization Stack

Five ways an AI video channel earns - and the honest maths behind each.

The thresholds you need to know

Programme	What you need	What it unlocks
Expanded YPP	500 subscribers, 3 public uploads in 90 days, plus 3,000 watch hours (12 months) or 3M Shorts views (90 days)	Fan funding, memberships, Super Thanks, Shopping
Full YPP (ads)	1,000 subscribers plus 4,000 watch hours (12 months) OR 10M Shorts views (90 days)	Ad revenue share and YouTube Premium revenue

Stream 1: Ad revenue

Stream 2: Affiliate income

Stream 3: Brand deals and sponsorships

Stream 4: Your own digital products

Stream 5: Services

CHAPTER 12

Growing Fast: Titles, Thumbnails, SEO

The packaging decides whether anyone ever sees the video you worked so hard to make.

Title formulas that work in India

- **The specific number:** 'How a Rs 5,000 SIP becomes Rs 9.5 lakh in 10 years'.
- **The mistake:** 'The one tax mistake that costs salaried employees thousands'.
- **The comparison:** 'Term insurance vs ULIP - which actually makes sense?'
- **The year:** 'Best mutual funds for 2026 - what the data says'.
- **The how-to:** 'How to check your credit score for free in 2026'.

Thumbnail rules

- 1 **One idea per thumbnail.** If a viewer cannot grasp it in half a second, it has failed.
- 2 **High contrast.** Bright text on a dark or busy background, or the reverse. It must pop at phone size.
- 3 **Three to four words maximum.** Large, readable text - never a paragraph.
- 4 **Consistent look.** The same colours and font across your channel build recognition in the feed.
- 5 **No misleading imagery.** Deceptive thumbnails violate policy and erode trust.

The Shorts plus long-form engine

SEO without the jargon

- Put the searched phrase in the title, the first line of the description, and the file name.
- Write a real 2-3 line description that says what the video delivers - it is indexed and it sets expectations.
- Add captions: search indexes the words you speak, and captions make them searchable.

- Publish in Q4: October to December ad spending peaks, and CPMs can be two to three times higher than early in the year.

CHAPTER 13

Selling AI Video as a Service in India

The fastest route to first revenue: make videos for businesses that need them and cannot make them.

Who buys, and what they need

Client	What they want	Typical Indian price
Coaching institutes	Course promos, result announcements, faculty intros	Rs 1,500 - Rs 5,000 per video
Local businesses	Social-media ads, offer videos, festival greetings	Rs 1,000 - Rs 4,000 per video
Real estate agents	Property walkthroughs and area explainers	Rs 2,000 - Rs 6,000 per video
D2C brands	Product demo ads, explainer videos	Rs 5,000 - Rs 25,000 per video
Professionals	Personal-brand intros, service explainers	Rs 1,500 - Rs 5,000 per video

A simple service menu to sell

- **Single promo video** - one 30-60 second vertical video, scripted and edited. Your entry offer.
- **Monthly pack** - four videos a month at a discount. Recurring revenue is the goal.
- **Ad creative bundle** - three to five variations for a client to test in paid campaigns.
- **Explainer video** - a longer 60-90 second video that explains a product or service.

Finding your first three clients

- 1 List twenty local businesses in one category you understand - clinics, coaching centres, restaurants.
- 2 Make one free sample video for each of three of them, in their style, and send it on WhatsApp.
- 3 Follow up with a simple offer: 'This one is free; if you like it, four a month for Rs X.'
- 4 Deliver fast, ask for a testimonial, and ask each happy client for one referral.

Pricing without underselling

CHAPTER 14

The 30-Day Launch Plan

From zero to a published, policy-safe channel in four weeks.

Week 1 - Decide and prepare

- Choose one niche and one wedge (Chapter 4). Write them down in a single sentence.
- Subscribe to Google AI Plus; set up a free Kling account for practice.
- Write your channel name, tagline and About page. Fill in the About page honestly - reviewers read it.
- Write your first five video ideas as titles, with a search phrase in each.

Week 2 - Build the machine

- Write two full scripts using the Chapter 5 template.
- Turn each into a shot list of five to eight beats.
- Generate all the clips in Flow using the six-part prompt formula.
- Assemble, caption and export your first finished video - but do not publish yet.

Week 3 - Publish and learn

- Publish your first long-form video and one Short cut from it.
- Publish two more videos across the week; keep the cadence.
- Watch your retention graph and note where viewers drop off. Fix that in the next script.
- Set the AI-use disclosure correctly on any realistic AI content.

Week 4 - Systemise and scale

- Batch: script three videos in one session, generate in another, edit in a third.
- Make one free sample video for a local business and send it (Chapter 13).
- Set up one affiliate link in a video description.
- Review your best-performing video and make two more in that direction.

CHAPTER 15

Common Mistakes That Kill New AI Channels

Twelve traps, in the order people usually fall into them.

- 1 **Starting with the tool, not the niche.** Pick the audience and the topic first; the tool is the easy part.
- 2 **Copying a saturated channel.** If your video could belong to someone else's channel, it belongs to no one's.
- 3 **One prompt per video.** Models generate seconds, not films. Work in shots.
- 4 **Ignoring YouTube's inauthentic-content rules.** Sameness gets a whole channel demonetized. Read Chapter 10 twice.
- 5 **Using AI personas as fake experts.** A synthetic 'doctor' or 'advisor' on sensitive topics is a direct monetization trap.
- 6 **Skipping AI disclosure on realistic content.** Undisclosed realistic AI is the risk - the label itself costs you nothing.
- 7 **Chasing views over retention.** A video watched to the end beats a video clicked and abandoned.
- 8 **Publishing silently.** No captions, no description, no SEO means search never finds you.
- 9 **Giving up in week three.** Almost every channel that fails, fails from inconsistency, not from bad content.
- 10 **Overspending on credits.** Generate cheap, keep the best, re-run only keepers.
- 11 **Waiting to be perfect.** Your tenth video will embarrass your first. Publish anyway.
- 12 **Only one income stream.** Stack ads, affiliate, brand deals, products and services.

The one habit that fixes most of them

CHAPTER 16

Three Complete Example Scripts

Full, ready-to-adapt scripts with their shot lists - so you never face a blank page.

Example 1: a finance explainer (long-form, about 8 minutes)

Beat	Shot (generate one clip)	Purpose
1	Close-up of a phone showing a falling graph; hand hovers over the sell button	Hook - tension
2	A calm wide shot of a person working while a chart rises in the background	Promise - relief
3	Animated table: monthly amount, years, final value	The maths
4	Time-lapse of a plant growing beside a falling-then-rising line	Why drops are normal
5	Split screen: 'stopped SIP' versus 'paused SIP'	The two mistakes
6	A simple bar chart comparing index versus active fund	The fix
7	Wide shot of the presenter's setup, tagline on screen	Loop to next video

Example 2: a short-form tool video (about 45 seconds)

Beat	Shot	On-screen text
1	Fast montage of three finished clips	3 FREE AI VIDEO TOOLS
2	Screen recording of tool one generating a clip	Tool 1 - free daily credits
3	Screen recording of tool two	Tool 2 - 10 free clips a month
4	Screen recording of tool three	Tool 3 - free assembly
5	Channel logo on a clean background	FOLLOW FOR PART 2

Example 3: a business case study (long-form, about 10 minutes)

Beat	Shot	Purpose
1	Old newspaper clippings and a heavy ledger	The problem
2	Animated timeline 2010 to today	The turning point
3	Rising bar chart of users	The result
4	A single word on screen: 'Trust'	The lesson

CHAPTER 17

The 90-Day Calendar and Batching System

Consistency is the whole game - and batching is how a busy person keeps it.

The twelve-week plan

Weeks	Long-form focus	Shorts (cut from the long-form)	Milestone
1-2	Foundation: your two best 'what is' explainers	3 per long-form	Channel live, first videos published
3-4	Comparison videos: A versus B	3 per long-form	Find your best-performing format
5-6	Mistake videos: 'the one thing that costs you'	3 per long-form	Approaching expanded-YPP thresholds
7-8	Case studies: 'how X grew'	3 per long-form	First affiliate links live
9-10	List videos: 'best of 2026'	3 per long-form	First brand conversation
11-12	Deep dives on your top three topics	3 per long-form	Double down on what worked

The batching rhythm

Session	Task	Time
Day 1	Research and write three scripts	90 minutes
Day 2	Turn scripts into shot lists and prompts	60 minutes
Day 3	Generate and keep the best clips	90 minutes
Day 4	Edit, caption, package and schedule	120 minutes

CHAPTER 18

AI Video for Paid Ads and Campaigns

The second, higher-paying service line: creative for clients who spend on advertising.

What advertisers actually need

Placement	Shape	Length	Hook style
Instagram / Facebook Reels ads	9:16 vertical	10-20 seconds	First-frame problem or offer
YouTube Shorts ads	9:16 vertical	6-15 seconds	Fast, visual, one idea
YouTube in-stream ads	16:9 landscape	15-30 seconds	Question or surprising fact
Display / Demand Gen	1:1 or 16:9	up to 10 seconds	Product-first, brand at the end

How to sell ad creative

- 1 Offer three to five variations of a single ad, not one - testing is what clients pay for.
- 2 Charge per bundle, not per video: 'five ad variations for Rs X'.
- 3 Deliver in the correct shapes and lengths the platforms want, named clearly.
- 4 Ask for the campaign result after two weeks; that number is your next proposal.

CHAPTER 19

Troubleshooting: When the Model Won't Cooperate

The ten problems every AI video creator hits, and the fix for each.

Problem	Why it happens	The fix
Flickering or morphing shapes	The model is guessing at unstable detail	Simplify the scene; reduce moving parts; keep the camera static
Wrong hands or extra fingers	Hands are the hardest thing for video models	Frame out the hands; use close-ups of objects instead
Character looks different each clip	No reference is held across generations	Use Flow's Ingredients panel with a reference image
Garbled on-screen text	Models rarely render text cleanly	Generate without text; add words in the editor as overlays
Audio out of sync with motion	Native audio is generated independently of timing	Trim and re-time in the edit; keep spoken lines short
The clip ignores half the prompt	Too many instructions in one prompt	One action per clip; split into two shots
Colours look washed out	Vague lighting instruction	Name the light: 'golden hour', 'dramatic side light'
The video feels stiff and lifeless	Static camera, no movement	Add a camera move: 'slow push in' or 'tracking shot'
Credits burn too fast	Generating at full quality before checking composition	Check at Lite or Fast, re-run only keepers at Quality
The video looks like everyone else's	Templated, unoriginal structure	Add your own research, numbers and point of view - the Chapter 10 rule

CHAPTER 20

Templates and Worksheets

Copy these into a notes app and reuse them for every video you ever make.

Template 1: the pre-publish checklist

- Niche and wedge confirmed - the video could only belong to my channel.
- Hook delivers the stake in the first five seconds.
- Script follows hook, promise, payoff, loop.
- Every shot is a single promptable action.
- Captions added and in sync.
- Music sits under the narration, never over it.
- AI disclosure set correctly if the content is realistic AI.
- Title has a number, a year, or a named product.
- Thumbnail passes the half-second test at phone size.
- Description written, with the search phrase in the first line.

Template 2: the client brief

Video brief

Client and business: _____

Goal of this video: (awareness / leads / sales / event) _____

Audience: who exactly will watch this? _____

Key message: the one thing they must remember _____

Format: shape (9:16 / 16:9), length in seconds _____

Style: energetic / calm / premium / playful _____

Call to action: what should the viewer do next? _____

Brand assets: logo, colours, font, contact details _____

Deadline and price: _____

Template 3: the thumbnail review

- 1 Can I understand it in half a second at phone size?
- 2 Is the text three to four words and fully readable?
- 3 Does the contrast make it pop against a busy feed?
- 4 Does it match the colours and font of my other thumbnails?
- 5 Is it honest - does the video deliver what the thumbnail promises?

Template 4: the weekly retention review

- Where is the biggest drop-off, and what was happening in the script there?
- Which video had the highest average view duration this week, and why?
- Which hook held the most viewers past the first thirty seconds?
- What will I change in next week's script because of this?

CHAPTER 21

90 Ready Video Topic Ideas

Three niches, thirty topics each - so your calendar is never empty.

Finance and money (30 topics)

- 1 How a Rs 5,000 monthly SIP grows over 10, 15 and 20 years
- 2 Index fund vs active fund: the real 10-year numbers
- 3 Emergency fund: how much is actually enough in 2026
- 4 How to read your payslip line by line
- 5 New tax regime vs old: which saves you more this year
- 6 The credit score mistake that quietly raises your interest rate
- 7 Term insurance vs ULIP: what the numbers say
- 8 How to start investing with Rs 500 a month
- 9 PPF vs ELSS vs NPS: which to choose first
- 10 The 50-30-20 budget, tested on a real Indian salary
- 11 How to build a Rs 1 lakh emergency fund on a modest salary

- 12 What happens to your EPF when you switch jobs
- 13 SIP vs lump sum: does timing really matter?
- 14 Five money habits that separate savers from spenders
- 15 How to check your CIBIL score for free
- 16 The true cost of a personal loan at 15 per cent
- 17 How to plan for your child's education in 2026
- 18 Gold vs mutual funds: where should a first investor start?
- 19 How much life cover do you actually need?
- 20 The tax on your crypto gains, explained simply
- 21 How to read a mutual fund fact sheet
- 22 Why your first mutual fund should probably be an index fund
- 23 How to save tax legally before the financial year ends
- 24 Debt trap: how minimum payments keep you poor
- 25 How to negotiate a higher salary at your next job
- 26 First salary: the five things to set up in month one
- 27 How to invest for retirement in your twenties
- 28 The difference between saving and investing, in one example
- 29 How to build a second income with your savings
- 30 Five free tools to track your money in India

Technology and AI (30 topics)

- 1 Three AI video tools that are free in India
- 2 How to use AI to write a resume that passes ATS
- 3 The best free AI tools for students in 2026
- 4 How to build a simple automation with no code
- 5 AI for small business: five tasks you can automate this week
- 6 How to use AI to study faster for exams
- 7 The AI tools worth paying for, and the ones that are not
- 8 How to make a faceless video with AI in under an hour
- 9 Five ways AI can help you find a job
- 10 How to spot an AI-generated scam message
- 11 AI for freelancers: winning more work with less admin
- 12 How to use AI to learn a new skill in 30 days
- 13 The truth about AI replacing jobs in India
- 14 How to write better prompts, with real examples
- 15 AI tools for teachers that actually save time
- 16 How to automate your invoices and follow-ups
- 17 AI image tools for small-business marketing
- 18 How to use AI to summarise long documents
- 19 Five AI mistakes beginners make
- 20 How to use AI to plan a business idea
- 21 AI for content creators: the full 2026 stack
- 22 How to protect your data while using AI tools

- 23 How to use AI to prepare for an interview
- 24 The best AI apps for your phone right now
- 25 How to use AI to manage your personal finances
- 26 AI for real estate agents: five practical uses
- 27 How to make a product ad with AI video
- 28 The AI skills employers actually want in 2026
- 29 How to use AI to write better emails
- 30 Five AI tools that will still be useful in five years

Education and skills (30 topics)

- 1 How to build a study timetable that you actually follow
- 2 The Pomodoro method, tested by an Indian student
- 3 How to revise a whole subject in one week
- 4 How to take notes that you actually revise from
- 5 Five free websites every Indian student should know
- 6 How to prepare for a competitive exam while working
- 7 How to improve your English speaking at home
- 8 The best way to memorise formulas
- 9 How to study effectively for long hours without burnout
- 10 How to choose a career after class 12
- 11 How to write a college application that stands out
- 12 How to prepare for campus placements
- 13 How to build a portfolio with no experience
- 14 Five skills that pay well in India in 2026
- 15 How to learn Excel from zero to job-ready
- 16 How to prepare for a government exam alongside a job
- 17 How to improve concentration in a distracting world
- 18 How to take better notes in online classes
- 19 How to prepare for a scholarship interview
- 20 How to plan a study-abroad application
- 21 How to build a personal learning plan
- 22 How to revise effectively in the last month before an exam
- 23 How to beat exam anxiety with a simple routine
- 24 How to choose the right online course
- 25 How to learn a new language in six months
- 26 How to build a habit that survives a busy week
- 27 How to prepare a project for a job interview
- 28 How to make the most of free online courses
- 29 How to prepare a subject you have never studied
- 30 How to stay consistent when motivation disappears

CHAPTER 22

Where to Verify Every Number

The sources behind this playbook, and where to check them before you spend.

- **Google AI plans, Flow and credits:** the Google AI subscriptions page and the Google Flow Help Centre.
- **Veo 3.1 capabilities and audio:** Google DeepMind's Veo model page.
- **Kling pricing and credits:** Kling's official membership page and credits policy.
- **Runway pricing and model credits:** Runway's official pricing and developer pricing pages.
- **YouTube monetization and inauthentic content:** YouTube Help - channel monetization policies and the July 2026 clarification.
- **AI disclosure rules:** YouTube Help - disclosing use of altered or synthetic content.
- **YPP thresholds:** YouTube Help - YouTube Partner Program overview and eligibility.
- **YouTube earnings context:** dated 2026 reporting on Indian CPM and RPM by niche.

CHAPTER 23

Three Niche Deep-Dives

Finance, technology and education - the audience, the sub-niches and the first ten videos.

Finance and money

First ten videos	Format	Why it works
How a Rs 5,000 SIP grows	Long-form, charts	Evergreen, high intent
Term vs whole-life insurance	Long-form, comparison	Highest-CPM topic
How to read your payslip	Long-form, annotated screen	Very high search volume
Index vs active funds	Long-form, bar charts	Loyal finance audience
Emergency fund basics	Short + long-form	Simple, shareable
Credit score mistakes	Long-form	Product-specific, affiliates
New vs old tax regime	Long-form, seasonal	Spikes Jan-Jul
PPF vs ELSS vs NPS	Long-form, comparison	Retirement intent
First salary: month one setup	Long-form	Reaches young earners
Five free money tools	Short	Reach and subscribers

Technology and AI

First ten videos	Format	Why it works
Three free AI video tools in India	Short	Timely, high curiosity
AI resume that passes ATS	Long-form, screen recording	Job-seeker intent
No-code automation for small business	Long-form, walkthrough	Business audience
Best free AI tools for students	Long-form, list	Huge student demand
How to spot an AI scam message	Short + long-form	Safety, shareable
AI for interview prep	Long-form	Career intent, affiliates
Five AI mistakes beginners make	Long-form	Evergreen
How to write better prompts	Long-form, examples	Foundational
AI stack for content creators	Long-form	Creator audience
AI skills employers want in 2026	Long-form	Trend-driven

Education and skills

First ten videos	Format	Why it works
A timetable you actually follow	Long-form, animated	Universal student problem
Revise a subject in one week	Long-form	Exam-season spike
How to take notes that work	Long-form	Evergreen, shareable
Five free sites every student needs	Short	Reach
English speaking at home	Long-form	High demand in tier-2 cities
Career after class 12	Long-form	High-intent decision
Campus placement prep	Long-form	Seasonal, placements
Skills that pay in India in 2026	Long-form	Trend-driven
Excel from zero to job-ready	Long-form series	Skill affiliate potential
Beat exam anxiety	Short + long-form	Emotional, shareable

CHAPTER 24

Client Communication Templates

The exact messages that turn a stranger into a paying client - copy and adapt.

1. First contact (WhatsApp)

Hello [name], I make short promotional videos using AI. I watched a few of your recent posts and made a free 30-second sample for [business] - may I send it to you? No cost, no obligation.

2. Follow-up (three days later)

Hi [name], just checking if the sample video reached you. If it is useful, I can make four a month for [price]. If not, no problem at all - I will not follow up again.

3. Proposal (email)

Subject: Video package for [business]

Hi [name], based on your goal of [goal], here is what I suggest: [number] videos a month, [format], delivered by [date], for [price]. I have attached two samples. Shall I start with this month's set?

4. Delivery (WhatsApp)

Here are this month's [number] videos, in the sizes you asked for. Upload them as they are - captions are already in place. If you want any change, tell me within a week and I will fix it free.

5. Upsell (after a good month)

Glad these worked. If you want to test paid ads, I can make five ad variations of your best video for [price] - that is usually where the biggest jump comes from. Interested?

CHAPTER 25

Worked Earnings Examples

Three honest scenarios, with the arithmetic shown - so your expectations are real.

Scenario	Monthly views	RPM	Ad income	Other income	Total
A. Hindi finance channel, month 8	300,000 long-form	Rs 90	Rs 27,000	Affiliate Rs 15,000	Rs 42,000
B. Tech channel, month 12	150,000 long-form + Shorts	Rs 55	Rs 8,250	Brand deal Rs 20,000	Rs 28,250
C. Service-first, month 3	Small channel	n/a	Rs 0	4 clients x Rs 4,000	Rs 16,000

What the scenarios do not show

- The first three months of the channel scenarios earned close to nothing - that is normal and expected.
- These are single months, not guarantees; a bad month can halve the ad income.
- Every rupee of the service income required active outreach, not passive publishing.
- All figures are gross; taxes and tool subscriptions come out of them.

CHAPTER 26

The First 1,000 Subscribers

The threshold that unlocks ad revenue - and the fastest honest way to cross it.

The four levers, in order of speed

Lever	How it works	Speed
Shorts for reach	Short-form is surfaced to new audiences fastest; end each Short by pointing to the long-form	Fastest
Search-first topics	Make videos people are already searching for; they keep delivering views for months	Fast
A repeatable series	A numbered or themed series gives viewers a reason to subscribe for the next one	Medium
Collaboration	Appear on or with another channel in your niche; borrow their audience	Variable

The habits that actually move the number

- 1 Publish one long-form video a week and cut three Shorts from it.
- 2 Open every video with the strongest hook you have, not an introduction.
- 3 Put a specific reason to subscribe in the middle and at the end - not just 'like and subscribe'.
- 4 Pick topics from search, not from your own head, for at least half of your uploads.
- 5 Study your retention graph weekly and fix the same weakness in the next script.

CHAPTER 27

Shorts: The Growth Engine, Done Right

Short-form is how a small channel gets found - if you use it as a system, not a lottery.

The three jobs of a Short

- **Reach:** put one sharp idea in front of people who have never heard of you.
- **Proof:** show in seconds that your content is worth more of their time.
- **Point:** send the interested few to your long-form video, where the watch hours and the revenue live.

The Shorts formula

- 1 Hook in the first line - a stake, a number, or a question. No introduction.
- 2 One idea only. A Short that tries to say three things says nothing.
- 3 Move the visual every one to two seconds; static Shorts die.
- 4 Captions on screen, word by word, because most viewers watch on mute.
- 5 End with a reason to watch the full video, said plainly.

Short type	Structure	Best for
The single tip	One useful fact, delivered fast	Reach and saves
The myth-buster	State a common belief, then correct it	Comments and shares
The clip	The strongest 45 seconds of a long-form video	Funnelling to the full video
The list	Three to five quick items on one theme	Watch time in the feed

APPENDIX A

The 60-Prompt Library

A. Video generation prompts (20)

1. Subject: a middle-aged Indian shopkeeper in a blue shirt. Action: counting notes at a counter. Setting: a small grocery shop in Mumbai, evening. Camera: medium shot, slow push in. Light and style: warm golden light, documentary. Audio: faint street traffic.
2. Subject: a young professional at a desk. Action: looking at a rising chart on a laptop. Setting: a home office, night. Camera: over-the-shoulder, static. Style: clean and modern. Audio: soft keyboard clicks, no music.
3. Subject: a hand dropping a coin into a glass jar. Action: the coin falls and settles. Setting: a plain white table. Camera: extreme close-up, static. Light: soft diffused. Audio: a single clear clink.
4. Subject: an animated bar chart. Action: bars rise in sequence. Setting: a clean navy background. Camera: static. Style: minimalist infographic. Audio: soft whoosh on each bar.
5. Subject: a farmer in a green field. Action: inspecting a crop. Setting: rural Maharashtra, morning. Camera: wide shot, slow pan. Light: golden hour. Audio: birds and a light breeze.

6. Subject: a smartphone on a table. Action: the screen lights up with a notification. Setting: a cafe table. Camera: close-up, static. Light: warm interior. Audio: a soft ping.
7. Subject: a delivery rider on a scooter. Action: riding through a busy street. Setting: an Indian city, daytime. Camera: tracking shot from the side. Style: energetic. Audio: horns and traffic.
8. Subject: a family at a dinner table. Action: sharing a meal and laughing. Setting: a modest Indian home, evening. Camera: wide shot, static. Light: warm lamp light. Audio: quiet conversation.
9. Subject: a coin stack growing taller. Action: stacks build one by one. Setting: a wooden surface. Camera: close-up, static. Style: clean and symbolic. Audio: soft placement sounds.
10. Subject: a teacher at a whiteboard. Action: writing a simple equation. Setting: a classroom. Camera: medium shot, slow zoom. Style: bright and friendly. Audio: marker on board.
11. Subject: a map of India. Action: a route draws across it. Setting: a navy background. Camera: static. Style: animated infographic. Audio: a soft rising tone.
12. Subject: a rupee note. Action: rotating slowly in the air. Setting: a dark studio. Camera: close-up, static. Light: dramatic side light. Audio: subtle ambient hum.
13. Subject: a laptop showing an AI video editor. Action: a timeline fills with clips. Setting: a creative studio. Camera: medium shot, slow push in. Style: modern. Audio: soft clicks.
14. Subject: a woman checking her phone on a train. Action: she smiles at the screen. Setting: an Indian local train, daytime. Camera: close-up, handheld. Style: candid documentary. Audio: train rumble.
15. Subject: a plant growing from soil. Action: a sprout rises in time-lapse. Setting: a simple pot. Camera: close-up, static. Light: soft daylight. Audio: gentle ambient tone.
16. Subject: a city skyline at dusk. Action: lights switch on across buildings. Setting: a metro skyline. Camera: wide shot, slow tilt up. Style: cinematic. Audio: distant city hum.
17. Subject: a scale weighing two items. Action: one side dips and settles. Setting: a clean studio. Camera: close-up, static. Style: symbolic comparison. Audio: a soft metallic settle.
18. Subject: a blank document filling with text. Action: words appear line by line. Setting: a desk. Camera: top-down, static. Light: natural. Audio: soft typing.
19. Subject: a shop front with a 'sale' sign. Action: a crowd walks past. Setting: a market street, evening. Camera: wide shot, static. Style: lively. Audio: market chatter.
20. Subject: a hand swiping through short videos. Action: each swipe changes the clip. Setting: a phone screen in frame. Camera: extreme close-up, static. Style: social-media native. Audio: quick soft swipes.

B. Script-writing prompts (10)

1. Write a 90-second YouTube script on [topic] for [audience]. Open with a hook that states the mistake and its cost, promise one clear outcome, deliver three numbered steps, and end with a loop to a related video. Keep sentences under 18 words.
2. Rewrite this script for text-to-speech: shorten every sentence, remove nested clauses, and replace hard-to-pronounce words. Output only the revised script. [paste script]
3. Turn this topic into a 45-second Short script with a hook in the first line, one idea, and a clear call to subscribe. [topic]
4. Write five hook lines for a video about [topic], each under 15 words, each creating a curiosity gap without clickbait.
5. Write a 10-minute long-form script on [topic] with a mid-roll ad break after minute four. Mark the break clearly.
6. Summarise this 10-minute script into a 60-second Short script that keeps the strongest single point. [paste script]
7. Write a script that compares [option A] and [option B] fairly, states the winner for a specific audience, and gives one caveat.
8. Draft a script for a business case study on how [Indian company] grew, with a narrative arc: problem, turning point, result, lesson.
9. Write a 90-second script that explains [concept] using one everyday Indian analogy, with no jargon.
10. Write three different endings for this script - one that loops, one that sells a product, one that asks a question. [paste script]

C. Hook and retention prompts (8)

1. Give me ten hook lines for a finance video aimed at salaried Indians, each naming a specific rupee amount or percentage.
2. Identify the weakest sentence in this script and rewrite it to be more specific. [paste script]
3. Where would a viewer most likely drop off in this script? Suggest one change to hold them. [paste script]
4. Write a five-second opening line that promises a specific payoff for a video titled '[title]'.
5. Rewrite this hook to remove all context and start with the stake. [paste hook]
6. Write a mid-video re-hook to place at the two-minute mark that restates the payoff. [topic]
7. Suggest three ways to end this video so the viewer watches a second one. [topic]
8. Turn this statistic into a hook line that a viewer cannot scroll past. [statistic]

D. Title and thumbnail prompts (8)

1. Write ten YouTube titles for a video about [topic], each under 60 characters, each containing a number, a year, or a named product.
2. Rewrite this title to be more specific and more searchable, keeping it under 60 characters. [title]
3. Suggest five thumbnail concepts for a video about [topic] - describe the image and the three-to-four-word overlay for each.
4. Write a thumbnail text overlay of no more than four words for a video titled '[title]'.
5. Give me five title variants that use the 'mistake' formula for [topic].
6. Write a title that compares two products for an Indian audience and states which wins. [products]
7. Create a title formula I can reuse for every video in the niche '[niche]'.
8. Suggest a consistent thumbnail colour scheme and font style for a [niche] channel, and explain why it stands out in the feed.

E. Research and niche prompts (6)

1. List twenty specific video topics for a faceless channel in the niche '[niche]', each phrased as a question a viewer would search.
2. Which sub-niche within [broad niche] has the least competition and the highest advertiser demand in India? Explain the reasoning.
3. Give me five wedge angles for a [niche] channel based on demographics, professions and life situations.
4. Outline a content plan of twelve videos for the first three months of a [niche] channel, in publishing order.
5. Summarise the top five questions viewers ask about [topic], based on what such audiences typically search for.
6. Suggest a channel name, tagline and About-page paragraph for a faceless [niche] channel.

F. Client and service prompts (8)

1. Write a 45-second promo video script for a [type of local business], focused on one clear offer and a call to visit.
2. Draft a WhatsApp message to a local [business type] offering one free sample AI video and a simple monthly package.
3. Create a three-tier service menu for an AI video freelancer in India, with per-video and monthly-pack prices.
4. Write a short proposal for a coaching institute that needs four promo videos a month, with a clear price and timeline.
5. Write three ad-creative variations for a D2C product, each with a different angle: problem, proof, and offer.
6. Draft a follow-up message to a client who received a free sample video but has not replied.
7. Write a client brief template I can send before starting a project, covering goal, audience, length, style and deadline.
8. Suggest five local business categories in my city most likely to buy AI video, and explain why each is a good fit.

APPENDIX B

Tool Comparison and Cost Worksheet

Pick a stack

Your situation	Recommended stack	Rough monthly cost
Absolute beginner, India	Google AI Plus + Kling free tier	Rs 399 (Rs 199 intro)
Serious solo creator	Google AI Pro + Kling Standard	Rs 1,950 + about Rs 620
Needs cinematic control	Runway Standard + Google AI Plus	about Rs 1,070 + Rs 399
Talking-head or localisation	HeyGen + Google AI Plus	about Rs 2,600 + Rs 399
Client work at volume	Google AI Pro + Kling Pro	Rs 1,950 + about Rs 2,900

Plan your credits before you spend

Line	How to fill it in	Example
Videos to publish	Your weekly target	1 long-form + 3 Shorts
Shots per video	From your shot list	about 6 per video, so 24 shots
Generations per shot	Allow for retakes	3
Total generations	Shots x generations	72
Credits per generation	Lite 10 / Fast 20 / Quality 100	20 (Fast)
Total credits needed	Generations x credits	1,440
Credits you have	From your plan	200 (AI Plus)
Gap	Buy top-ups or trim shots	Trim to fit, or upgrade

The AI Video Creator Playbook - India Edition 2026

A Digitalaikart original. Verify current prices and policies before you subscribe.

APPENDIX C

Glossary of AI Video Terms

Term	What it means
Text-to-video	Generating a video clip from a written prompt.
Image-to-video	Animating a still image into motion; the starting image guides the result.
Native audio	Sound, dialogue and effects generated in the same pass as the video (Veo 3.1, Gemini Omni Flash).
Credits	The currency AI video tools spend per generation; subscriptions top them up monthly.
RPM	Revenue per 1,000 views - your actual earnings after YouTube's share.
CPM	Cost per 1,000 ad impressions - what advertisers pay, before YouTube's cut.
YPP	YouTube Partner Program - the scheme that lets a channel earn from ads and fan funding.

Term	What it means
Faceless channel	A channel with no on-camera host; narration and visuals carry it.
Shorts	YouTube's vertical, sub-60-second video format; strong for reach, weak for revenue.
Mid-roll ad	An ad inserted inside a video over 8 minutes; lifts RPM substantially.
Ingredients	Google Flow's reference-image feature for keeping characters and objects consistent.
SceneBuilder	Google Flow's timeline for arranging and extending clips.
Inauthentic content	YouTube's term for repetitive, mass-produced or manipulative content that cannot be monetized.
AI disclosure	The upload setting that labels realistic AI-generated content for viewers.
Kinetic captions	Captions where the current word highlights as it is spoken; lifts retention.
Hook	The opening seconds designed to stop the scroll and promise a payoff.
Retention	The share of a video viewers keep watching; the metric the algorithm rewards most.
Wedge	A narrow, specific audience position you can own (e.g. finance for women).

APPENDIX D

Frequently Asked Questions

Do I need any experience to start?

No. The playbook starts from a blank page and builds the whole pipeline step by step. If you can write a script and follow a checklist, you can make an AI video.

Is a faceless channel allowed on YouTube?

Yes. YouTube does not require an on-camera host. Faceless documentaries, explainers and animations can monetize as long as each video adds genuine original value.

Will my AI channel get demonetized?

Not for using AI. It can be demonetized for sameness, manipulation, or fake AI 'experts' on sensitive topics. Chapter 10 shows exactly how to stay on the right side of the line.

Which tool should I start with in India?

Google AI Plus, because it is the only major video AI that bills in rupees with UPI and needs no forex card, paired with Kling's free daily credits for practice.

How much will it cost me each month?

A serious start is around Rs 399 (or Rs 199 for the first six months) for Google AI Plus. Kling's free tier costs nothing. Add tools only when your format needs them.

Do I have to disclose that my video is AI?

You must disclose realistic AI content that could mislead a viewer - during upload, in YouTube Studio, under Attributes, using the 'AI use' field. Clearly animated or stylised content does not need it. Disclosing does not reduce your reach or earnings.

How long until I earn money?

Ad revenue follows the YouTube thresholds and usually takes months. Faster income comes from affiliate links and, quickest of all, from selling AI video as a service to local businesses (Chapter 13).

Can I use AI voiceovers?

Yes. Modern text-to-speech is good enough for narration, especially in Hindi. Just do not present a synthetic voice as a human expert on health, law, finance or politics.

What if a clip comes out wrong?

Regenerate that one shot, changing a single variable. Do not restart the whole video. Chapter 19 lists the ten common failures and their fixes.

How often should I publish?

One long-form video a week plus three Shorts cut from it is a realistic, sustainable cadence for a solo creator - and consistency beats volume.

Is this playbook India-specific?

Yes. The tool prices are in rupees, the niches and CPM data are Indian, and the service pricing reflects what Indian clients actually pay.

How current is the information?

Every price, policy and earning range was verified against official sources in October 2026. Because this market moves quickly, always confirm the current figure before you subscribe.

APPENDIX E

The One-Page Cheat Sheet

Choose

Pick one niche and one narrow wedge. Confirm it is faceless-friendly and high-CPM.

Write your niche in a single sentence before you touch a tool.

Build

Script first: hook, promise, payoff, loop. Keep sentences short for the voice.

Shot list next: 4 to 10 single-action beats. One prompt per beat.

Prompt with the six-part formula: subject, action, setting, camera, light, audio.

Produce

Generate cheap, keep the best, re-run only keepers at quality.

Add narration, music at a quarter volume, and captions on every video.

Cut every three to five seconds. Export 9:16 for Shorts and 16:9 for long-form.

Protect

Add real value to every video - no templates, no sameness, no fake AI experts.

Disclose realistic AI content during upload. Faceless is allowed; laziness is not.

Publish and grow

One long-form a week, three Shorts cut from it. Search-first titles, honest thumbnails.

Review retention weekly. Double down on what worked.

Get paid

Stack the streams: ads, affiliate, brand deals, your own products, and services.

Sell AI video to local businesses now; let the channel compound for later.

APPENDIX F

Sample 30-Day Publishing Calendar

Week	Long-form video	Shorts (cut from it)	Batch sessions
1	Your best 'what is' explainer	3 clips, each with its own hook	Script Mon, generate Wed, edit Fri

Week	Long-form video	Shorts (cut from it)	Batch sessions
2	A comparison: A versus B	3 clips from the comparison	Script Mon, generate Wed, edit Fri
3	A mistake video: 'the one thing that costs you'	3 clips from the mistake	Script Mon, generate Wed, edit Fri
4	A case study or a 'best of 2026' list	3 clips from the case study	Script Mon, generate Wed, edit Fri